

Question 9 · Unit 1 · 8 Marks

A growing organisation is facing skill gaps and declining employee performance. Suggest an HRD-oriented approach to address these issues.

Introduction

This is an application question. Do not write ‘conduct training’ as the only sentence. An HRD-oriented approach means: diagnose first, fix climate, use all subsystems (appraisal, counselling, training, career), involve line managers, and evaluate. A growing organisation has extra pressure — new markets, more staff, stretched supervisors — so skill gaps and falling performance often appear together.

Detailed points

- 1. Diagnose before prescribing.** Collect facts: which jobs, which errors, new vs old employees, whether tools and processes are adequate. Use organisation–task–person analysis. If the real cause is overloaded systems or unclear strategy, training will not help. HRD honesty starts here.
- 2. Restore or build HRD climate.** In a growing firm, bosses are busy and become short-tempered. Fear hides skill gaps. Create psychological safety: mistakes discussed, questions allowed. Without climate, people will not admit they cannot do the new work.
- 3. Developmental performance appraisal, not punishment.** Use appraisal to name specific gaps and agree improvement plans. Declining performance should trigger counselling, not only a low rating. Ratings without help increase decline.
- 4. Targeted learning mix.** From TNA, design on-the-job coaching for practical skills, short formal programmes for new technology, and buddy systems for new hires. Growing organisations should not copy a 5-day generic ‘motivation’ workshop.
- 5. Strengthen the boss as coach.** Train supervisors in feedback and coaching. In growth, many supervisors are recently promoted experts who never learned to develop others. This is often the hidden cause of team skill gaps.
- 6. Career and potential for a growing structure.** Growth creates new roles. Map who can fill them; start developing before the gap becomes a crisis. Skill gaps are partly ‘we grew faster than we developed people’.
- 7. Quick wins plus system fix.** Fix urgent error-producing skill gaps first (safety, customer, quality), then install a yearly HRD cycle so the problem does not return. Growing firms need both firefighting and a system.
- 8. Evaluate and iterate.** Measure whether errors fall, productivity recovers, and employees feel more capable. If not, return to diagnosis. HRD is a process without a full stop.

Conclusion. Frame the answer as a step-by-step HRD approach: *diagnose → climate → developmental appraisal/counselling → need-based training and coaching → career for growth roles → evaluate*. Show you will not treat HRD as a single training event.